

Chapter 22-2

//

Near evening, Xu Qingzhu received a phone call from Bai Weiwei.

Afterward, she hurriedly drove out.

Xu Qingya watched her retreating figure and asked in confusion, "What happened?"

But she got no answer.

At that time, Liang Shi was in her room preparing materials she'd need for work. The original body's graduation certificate had been thrown into some corner by her, and Liang Shi had to search for quite a while to find it.

Back then, the original body had attended a diploma mill¹—she only had a graduation certificate, no degree certificate.

However, the photo on the graduation certificate was quite youthful and eye-catching.

Shoulder-length hair, a radiant smile.

Liang Shi sighed—time really was a merciless killer.

And photos really could be deceiving.

Anyone looking at it would never think the person in the photo was a profligate wastrel with cruel methods.

She organized everything neatly, then went downstairs.

Only Xu Qingya was in the living room. She asked, "Where's your sister?"

"She just went out," Xu Qingya said. "It seems Sister Weiwei had something urgent to discuss with her."

Liang Shi: "I see."

She didn't think much of it.

But at nine o'clock in the evening, Xu Qingzhu still hadn't returned.

Liang Shi waited in her room for quite a while, glancing toward the door from time to time.

At some moment, for some reason, she felt like she had become a "waiting wife stone"².

She was so bored that she had already removed the carpet and found a new one from another room to lay down.

Stepping on the soft carpet, she always felt like something was about to happen.

At nine-twenty, Liang Shi couldn't help but call Xu Qingzhu.

It kept ringing, but no one answered.

She sent several WeChat messages.

Still no response.

Text messages were the same.

She found a jacket and went downstairs. The first floor was empty and eerily quiet.

Her footsteps on the solid wood stairs made clicking sounds.

Cold and lonely.

The unease in Liang Shi's heart grew stronger.

She called Xu Qingzhu's number again—it went straight to voicemail.

Just as she was about to call again, she received a multimedia message.

It was from an unknown number. The photo showed a dimly lit private room filled with swirling smoke, where a group of people sat around a circular table—both men and women, all wearing dissolute smiles on their faces.

Bai Weiwei and Xu Qingzhu sat under the dim yellow lighting. Bai Weiwei was clearly drunk, and Xu Qingzhu wasn't much better off.

In front of them were six wine glasses and a dice.

Liang Shi frowned and was about to ask where this was.

The other party had already sent a message.

【Liang Shi, you're about to be cheated on.】

Liang Shi: 【Who are you? Where is this?】

A few seconds later, a text came: 【Your wife is playing Russian roulette³ with people at Huayue International.】

【If you're much later, who knows whether they'll be spinning for drinks or people.】

Footnotes:

¹ **Diploma mill:** A term for institutions that grant degrees with little or no academic study required, often considered to have no academic credibility.

² **Waiting wife stone:** A Chinese idiom referring to a legendary rock formation said to resemble a woman waiting for her husband's return—used metaphorically to describe someone waiting anxiously for a loved one.

³ **Russian roulette:** Here referring to a drinking game where participants spin to determine who drinks, but the sender implies it might escalate to more dangerous activities.